

LYCANTHROPHES IN EBERRON

What if werewolves of Eberron were twelve different “tribes”, each impacted by a different moon of Eberron?

This book is inspired by the homebrewed lunar calendar of Eberron by abexy and the classical World of Darkness game, Werewolf: the Apocalypse by White Wolf.

The rules are intended for players to play as lycanthropes, specifically werewolves, in Eberron campaigns.

NEW RULES OF LYCANTROPY

In D&D 5e, lycanthropy is a curse or disease that can be contracted through a bite or scratch from a lycanthrope. In this version, lycanthropy comes in two forms: a **hereditary** form passed down through bloodlines, and a **contracted** form that is caught like a disease. If it is hereditary, the character is born with lycanthropy, and this cannot be removed, short of a *wish* spell.

HEREDITARY LYCANTHROPY

A character with either a parent with hereditary lycanthropy has a 50% chance of inheriting the trait. If both parents have hereditary lycanthropy, it is guaranteed. The probability decreases to 25% (4 on a 1d4) if only one grandparent has hereditary lycanthropy, and 12.5% (8 on a 1d8) if only one great-grandparent has it, and so on. Overall, in the world of Eberron, hereditary lycanthropy is rare but persistent.

Werewolves, the most common type of hereditary lycanthropes, have an affinity to one of the twelve moons of Eberron, which influences their lycanthropic form and abilities. Werewolves of the same moon tend to form close-knit packs or tribes, often centered around shared beliefs and customs related to their moon.

Through parent to cub, werewolves pass down not only their lycanthropic nature but also knowledge of their moon’s influence, rituals, and

POWER & INTENTION

The rules are intended to create slightly more powerful characters, but also give new challenges. Werewolves are physically powerful, but struggle to have control over their transformations and instincts, and are actively hunted by the Silver Flame. This is in the spirit of the personal horror themes of W:tA, and the struggle to maintain one’s humanity.

traditions. Each one of the moons correspond to a tribe, and the traditions are detailed below.

Finally, werewolves with hereditary lycanthropy have control over their transformations, and are able to hold in-between forms as well - five forms in total.

Conceptually, “Hereditary Lycanthrophes” are what Keith Baker refers to as “alpha” in his blog post, [here](#).

CONTRACTED LYCANTHROPY

A character bitten or scratched by a lycanthrope must make a DC 12 Constitution saving throw. On a failed save, the character “is cursed” with lycanthropy, as per the original rules.

They cannot pass this on to their offspring, even if they become a lycanthrope themselves. They can, however “infest” others through bites and scratches, as per the original rules.

If they embrace their lycanthropy, they can get feats to control their transformations and gain abilities based on the moon that influenced the lycanthrope that infected them.

They gain all the benefits and drawbacks of lycanthropy, including the five forms detailed below.

THE FORMS

A lycanthrope has five forms:

HEREDITARY LYCANTHROPY

Hereditary Lycanthropy is overpowered in the spirit of the “Werewolf: the Apocalypse (W:tA)” which this is inspired by. The DM can use these rules to create powerful NPC lycanthropes, that is an option. However, the actual intention is to play a game with themes from W:tA: personal horror, fight against cosmic forces, the balance between human and beast, and the struggle to maintain one’s humanity. To accommodate this, the hereditary lycanthropy is made into a class progression, based on better control of their shifts and abilities. It makes most sense to play with a full party of hereditary lycanthropes, similar to W:tA to keep the game balanced and relevant to all players.

CONTRACTED LYCANTHROPY

The rules in this book are written for consistency with the original D&D 5e werewolf. The 5e monster stat block for werewolves roughly corresponds to the Hybrid form detailed below, for an NPC of the 8th level. This means that DMs can use the original werewolf stat block for NPC lycanthropes without creating immersion-breaking inconsistencies. If a player wants their character to have the contracted lycanthropy “curse”, they can continue their usual character progression and can access to the feats below.

- **Humanoid Form:** The lycanthrope appears as a normal humanoid of their race.
- **Shifter Form:** The lycanthrope takes on a mix of humanoid and animal features, gaining some of the abilities of their animal form. In this form, they resemble Shifters.
- **Hybrid Form:** This is the hybrid form from D&D 5e.
- **Dire Form:** The lycanthrope takes on a larger and more powerful version of their animal form, gaining enhanced abilities.
- **Animal Form:** The lycanthrope fully transforms into their animal form.

Contracted lycanthropes have no control over their transformations and will shift into their Hybrid form during a full moon. However, hereditary lycanthropes have control over their shifts and can choose to shift into any of the five forms.

To shift between these forms, the lycanthrope must use an action on their turn. They can shift only to the next form up or down the list as one action. For example, they can shift from Humanoid to Shifter, or from Hybrid to Dire, but not Humanoid to Hybrid takes two turns.

This transformation, “shifting”, requires a Wisdom check. If their moon is dark (new moon), the check is made with disadvantage. If their moon is full, the check is made with advantage. The DC of the check is 18 - the character level in the werewolf class/2 (rounded down), as per the table below. This means that early on, the characters will not be able to rely on their shifting abilities as much, outside of the full moon phase. To determine the phase of the moon, either use a d10, with 5 being new moon and 0 being full moon, or use the amazine the homebrewed lunar calendar of Eberron by abexy.¹

SHIFTING DC BY LEVEL

Level	Shifting DC
1-2	17
3-4	16
5-6	15
7-8	14
9-10	13
11-12	12
13-14	11
15-16	10
17-18	9
19-20	8

The transformation is a magical effect. On the turn, this will register as such on spells like *detect magic*. It can be suppressed by *antimagic field* or similar effects, but not dispelled. At the

¹There are other sources about the cosmology of the moons in Eberron.

DM's discretion, *counterspell* may be used to prevent a lycanthrope from shifting if cast as a reaction before they use their action to shift. Alternatively, the roll may be made at a disadvantage. The lycanthrope can try again on their next turn.

Each one of the forms come with their own set of abilities and traits, which are detailed in the next sections for werewolves.

HUMANOID FORM

In this form, the werewolf appears as a normal humanoid of their race.

Exhaustion. When shifting back to this form from any other form, the werewolf suffers one level of exhaustion.

Vulnerability. Werewolves in all forms have vulnerability to silver and silvered weapons.

SHIFTER FORM

In this form, the werewolf resembles a Longtooth Shifter with relatively heavy build and will likely be mistaken for one.²

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 2, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 1, also up to a maximum of 25.

Damage Resistance. They gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Vulnerability. Werewolves in all forms have vulnerability to silver and silvered weapons.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell.

Claw Attack. Their unarmed strikes deal 1d6 slashing damage, plus their strength modifier. They count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage. They are proficient with this attack.

HYBRID FORM

This is the majestic, impressive werewolf look - it is the hybrid form from D&D 5e.

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 6 from their human form, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 3, also up to a maximum of 25.

Damage Immunity. They gain immunity to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Vulnerability. Werewolves in all forms have vulnerability to silver and silvered weapons.

²If a check is needed, the DC is 19 to identify them as a lycanthrope rather than a Shifter on a Nature (Wis) or Arcana (Int) check. However, unless there is a specific reason to suspect a lycanthrope, people will assume they are a Shifter without any checks.

Lack of Speech. They lose the ability to speak, and social checks other than Intimidation automatically fail. Magical communication such as *tongues* or *telepathy* still work, but they cannot cast the spell themselves.

Casting Spells. They cannot cast spells or concentrate on them.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell.

Claw Attack. Their unarmed strikes deal 2d4 slashing damage, plus their strength modifier. They count as magical for the purpose of overcoming resistance and immunity to nonmagical attacks and damage. They are proficient with this attack.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d8 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

DIRE FORM

In this form, the werewolf takes on a look similar to a dire wolf, but larger and more powerful.

Attribute Bonuses. Their Strength increases by 4 from their human form, up to a maximum of 25, and their Dexterity increases by 2, also up to a maximum of 25.

Damage Resistance. They gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage from nonmagical weapons that aren't silvered.

Vulnerability. Werewolves in all forms have vulnerability to silver and silvered weapons.

Lack of Speech. They lose the ability to speak, and social checks other than Intimidation are automatically failed.

Casting Spells. They cannot cast spells or concentrate on them.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d8 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

Proficiency Bonus. They gain proficiency with Stealth and Perception skills.

ANIMAL FORM

In this form, the werewolf fully transforms into a wolf.

Vulnerability. Werewolves in all forms have vulnerability to silver and silvered weapons.

Lack of Speech. They lose the ability to speak, and social checks other than Intimidation are automatically failed.

Casting Spells. They cannot cast spells or concentrate on them.

Keen Hearing and Smell. The werewolf has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing and smell.

Bite Attack. They can use their action to make a bite attack, dealing 1d4 piercing damage plus their strength modifier. They are proficient with this attack. This attack can also transmit lycanthropy if the target fails a DC 12 Constitution saving throw.

Pack Tactics. If they have an ally within 5 feet of their target, they have advantage on attack rolls against that target.

INVOLUNTARY SHIFTING

Contracted lycanthropes must shift into their Hybrid form during a full moon. Hereditary lycanthropes do not have to shift - they have control over their shifts. However, there are certain conditions which can cause them to shift unwillingly:

- Taking damage from a silver weapon
- Entering the *frightened* condition
- *Vicious Mockery* spell
- *Tasha's Caustic Brew* spell
- DM's discretion: once every full moon

If these take place, the lycanthrope must make a Wisdom saving throw. The DC of the check is 18 - the character level in the werewolf class/2 (rounded down). On a failed save, they immediately shift into their Hybrid form. On a successful save, they can choose to resist the shift, and do not need to roll again for 24 hours. If their moon is full, they have disadvantage on this saving throw. If their moon is new, (dark moon) they have advantage on this saving throw. Finally, being under the effect of the spell *Calm Emotions* gives advantage.

WEREWOLF CLASS

The hereditary werewolf is a class. If a character has hereditary lycanthropy, (or just found that they do) they can take levels in this class.

WEREWOLF CLASS

Level	Proficiency	Shifting DC	Extra
1	+2	17	
2	+2	17	
3	+2	16	Moon Feature
4	+2	16	Feat
5	+3	15	
6	+3	15	Moon Feature
7	+3	14	
8	+3	14	Feat
9	+4	13	
10	+4	13	Moon Feature
11	+4	12	
12	+4	12	Feat
13	+5	11	
14	+5	11	Moon Feature
15	+5	10	
16	+5	10	Feat
17	+6	9	
18	+6	9	Moon Feature
19	+6	8	Feat
20	+6	8	

THE MOONS

Moon Features represent instinctual, supernatural advantages granted by the character's dominant moon. A character selects one Moon at level 3. Additional Moon Features are gained at levels 6, 10, 14, and 18.

Unless stated otherwise, Moon Features apply in Shifter, Hybrid, Dire, and Animal forms.

ZARANTYR, STORM

OLARUNE, SENTINEL

THERENDOR, HEALING

FEATURES FROM THERENDOR

Jump. Same as the *Jump* spell. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Available Forms Hybrid, Dire, Animal

Humanoid Jump. Same as the feature *Jump* above, except it is available in all forms.

Available Forms Humanoid, Shifter, Hybrid, Dire, Animal

Prerequisites Jump, as above.

Jump II. All *Jump* features now require only a short rest to replenish.

Available Forms As per the
Prerequisites Jump, as above.

Lick Wounds. As an action, you can lick a creature and restore hit points equal to 1d8 + your werewolf level. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Available Forms Shifter, Hybrid, Dire, Animal
Prerequisites Level 3

Lick Wounds II. *Lick Wounds* require only a short rest to replenish.

Available Forms Humanoid, Shifter, Hybrid, Dire, Animal

Prerequisites Jump, as above.

EYRE, MAKING

Werewolves under the auspices of the moon Eyre find themselves drawn to human settlements and cities. There are likely a few packs underneath Sharn, near the manifest zone of Fernia. Their survival strategy is to be close to the humans.

MOON FEATURES

DRAVAGO, HANDLING

NYMM, HOSPITALITY

LHARVION, DETECTION

BARRAKAS, FINDING

All werewolves have *Keen Hearing and Smell* in non-humanoid forms, but werewolves of Barrakas have it in all forms.

MOON FEATURES

Eternal Dawn. When you shift into your Hybrid form, you can choose to emit a burst of radiant light. Each creature of your choice that you can see within 10 feet of you must succeed on a DC 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Strength modifier Constitution saving throw or be blinded until the end of your next turn. You can use this feature a number of times equal to your proficiency bonus, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Available Forms Hybrid

Prerequisites Level 3

RHAAN, SCRIBING

SYPHEROS, SHADOW

ARYTH, PASSAGE

VULT, WARDING

In the wolf form, all werewolves have *Pack Tactics*, but werewolves of Vult have it in all forms.

CRYA, THE LOST MOON

HISTORY OF LYCANTHROPY IN EBERRON